

A Tale of Two Rivers

LONG long ago, Teesta was a river **goddess** and Rangeet, a river god. They were good friends and **dwelled** in the **lap** of the **mighty** Himalayas. One day, the two rivers decided to race each other down the mountain to see who would reach the plains first.

Teesta asked the snake king to guide her. Rangeet chose the bird king to be his guide. The race began and the rivers flowed down through **breathtaking** forests and **valleys**. The snake king **glided** easily on the ground and followed a straight path. **As a result**, Teesta's course was straight. The bird king, however, would stop every now and then to **snack** on a tasty worm or insect. Rangeet would also have to stop and urge the bird king to move ahead and not waste time. As a result, Rangeet's course was not as straight as Tista's.

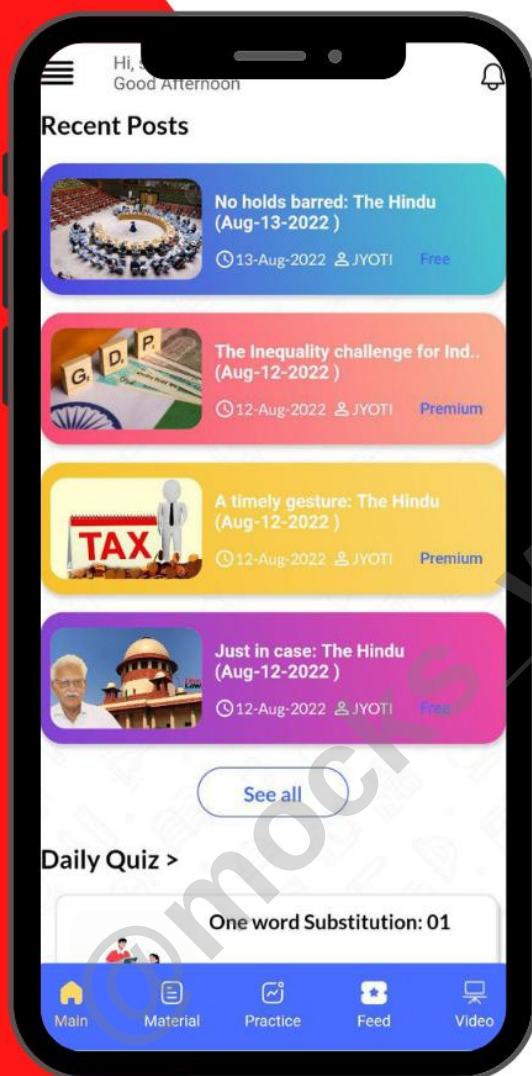


Teesta reached the plains first. When Rangeet saw this, he was very angry. He was unhappy about losing the race, and **in a fit of rage**, he started flowing all over the place, destroying anything that came in his path. Teesta watched him, **frightened**. She **called out** to her dear friend to **calm down** and stop the **destruction**. Rangeet heard her sweet voice **pleading** with him, and after calming down, he went to meet her.

The Lepchas of Sikkim consider the place where the two gods met as holy. Every year, they gather at the **confluence** of the Teesta and Rangeet rivers to celebrate the **feast** of the river god and goddess.

Vocabulary

1. **Tale** (noun) – story, narrative, fable, legend, yarn – कहानी
2. **Goddess** (noun) – female deity, divine woman, celestial being, idol, supernatural woman – देवी
3. **Dwell** (verb) – live, reside, inhabit, stay, lodge – निवास करना / रहना
4. **Lap** (noun) – bosom, cradle, fold, embrace, shelter – गोद / आश्रय
5. **Mighty** (adjective) – powerful, strong, great, immense, forceful – शक्तिशाली / महान
6. **Breath-taking** (adjective) – stunning, magnificent, splendid, amazing, awe-inspiring – शानदार / मंत्रमुग्ध कर देने वाला
7. **Valley** (noun) – dale, ravine, canyon, hollow, gorge – घाटी
8. **Glide** (verb) – slide, flow, move smoothly, skim, drift – फिसलना / सरकना
9. **As a result** (phrase) – consequently, therefore, hence, thus, so – परिणामस्वरूप
10. **Snack** (verb) – nibble, munch, eat lightly, graze, bite – हल्का भोजन करना
11. **In a fit of rage** (phrase) – angrily, in fury, in anger, in wrath, in temper – गुस्से में / क्रोधावेश में
12. **Frighten** (verb) – scare, terrify, alarm, intimidate, startle – डराना
13. **Call out** (phrasal verb) – shout, yell, cry out, appeal, summon – पुकारना / चिल्लाना
14. **Calm down** (phrasal verb) – relax, settle, compose, soothe, pacify – शांत होना / कराना
15. **Destruction** (noun) – ruin, devastation, annihilation, wreckage, demolition – विनाश / तबाही
16. **Plead** (verb) – beg, request, implore, appeal, entreat – गुहार लगाना / विनती करना
17. **Confluence** (noun) – junction, meeting point, convergence, union, intersection – संगम
18. **Feast** (noun) – celebration, banquet, festival, gala, meal – भोज / उत्सव



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